

Futurism

The most important Italian avant-garde art movement of the 20th century, Futurism celebrated machines, speed, violence and modernity. From 1909 to 1918, its artists determined to destroy Italian traditions and create a new art that embraced movement, technology and energy. Most believed the machine age would improve everyone's lives. In 1909, the poet and editor Filippo Tommaso Marinetti (1876–1944) wrote a Futurist manifesto, praising youth, machines, power and speed, and declaring he would destroy art galleries and museums, liberating Italy from its past.

The Futurists first exhibited in Milan in 1911, and later in various other European cities, creating a stir in each. Futurists such as Umberto Boccioni (1882–1916), Carlo Carrà, Gino Severini (1883–1966), Giacomo Balla (1871–1958) and Antonio Sant'Elia (1888–1916) adopted elements of Post-Impressionism, Symbolism, Divisionism and Cubism. In turn, Futurism influenced Art Deco, Constructivism, Surrealism and Dada. Enthusiasm for technology led them to naively celebrate the start of the First World War.



Boccioni, *Unique Forms of Continuity in Space*, 1913